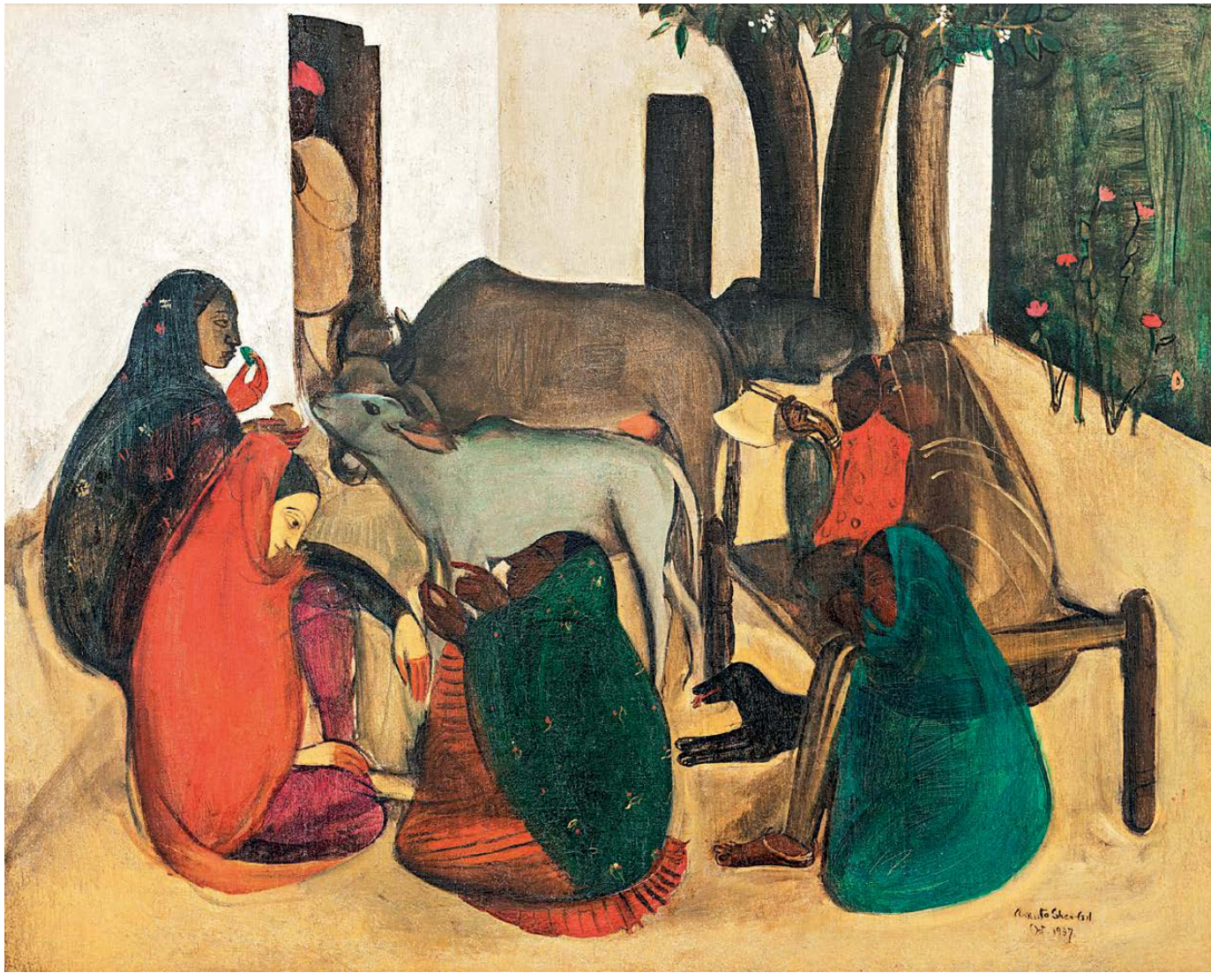
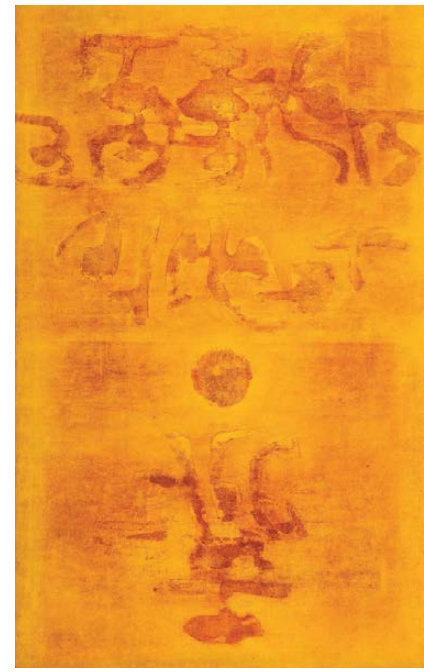


In 2023, Saffronart—India's leading auction house that is celebrating its 25th anniversary this year—sold an Amrita Sher-Gil painting called *The Story Teller* for ₹61.80 crore, way above its estimate of between ₹28-38 crore, creating a record for Modern Indian Art. But in mid March this year, that record was shattered when Christie's sold Maqbool Fida Husain's Untitled (*Gram Yatra*) for $13.75 million (₹119 crore), making it the most expensive Modern Indian painting ever sold. In April last year, online auction house, AstaGuru sold a stainless steel and resin sculpture by Anish Kapoor for ₹9.61 crore, almost double of its estimate of ₹5 crore. The recently concluded 16th edition of the India Art Fair, the country's largest art exhibition saw a record number of 120 exhibitors with galleries such as Vadhera Art Gallery selling 90 per cent of their booth on the first day with prices ranging from $2,500 to $300,000, including works by Sudhir Patwardhan, Atul Dodiya, Shilpa Gupta, and Vivan Sundaram.

The Indian art market at auction was valued at over $144 million (₹1,253 crore) in 2023, as per the 'State of



Clockwise from opposite page: Stainless steel and resin sculpture by Anish Kapoor; Amrita Sher-Gil's 'The Story Teller'; V S Gaitonde's Untitled work